



Interview Questions.....

Interview questions can be divided into the following broad categories

- About you.
- About your career.
- About the organisation/job.

About you questions

Tell me about yourself.

How would you describe yourself in five words?

What are you good at?

How do you work in a team?

What personal self-development do you think you need?

What type of people do you find easiest to work with/for?

What type of people do you find difficult to work with/for?

How do you get the best out of people?

How did your school reports describe you?

What are your interests?

What are your achievements?

What key skills can you offer?

What does a busy day involve for you?

If you could start again, what different career decisions would you make?

Where do you see yourself in (XX) years?

What are your strengths and weaknesses?

How do you operate under stress?

What would your boss/colleague/friends say about you?

What motivates/demotivates you?

What salary level are you seeking?

About your career questions

Tell me about your work experiences to date.

What have been your most significant jobs throughout your career?

The reasons for this.

If you could start again, what different career decisions would you make?

What's the reason you have been so long/so short with your present employer?

How successful has your career to date been?

What has been your biggest career disappointment?

About the organisation/job

What made you apply for this position?

Tell me what you know about this organisation.

How do you deal with routine tasks?

How do you approach a typical project?

Tell me the reason/s we should employ you?

Tips for asking questions

Always prepare questions in advance and ask them. Lack of questions can indicate lack of preparation and disinterest.

Ask **open questions** i.e. ones that initiate a conversation & information rather than **closed** i.e. questions that initiate simple 'yes' or 'no' answers.

Open

What

Where

When

How

Who

Closed

Do

Can

Did

Would

Will

Example questions

Personal judgement needs to be used in terms of what questions to ask. If you feel you have built strong rapport with the interviewer/s you may feel it is appropriate to ask more bold questions especially towards the close of the interview. One thing to avoid is asking 'me' focused questions (working hours/holidays/remuneration) as your first ones e.g. questions focused on benefits to you, rather than asking about the organisation job and/or what value you can bring to either/both.

- What is the reason for the vacancy?
- What are the success factors of the job/the person?
- What will the most challenging part of the job be?
- What structural/organisation changes are planned?
- What is the company culture/management style?
- How has the company changed over the last few years?
- Where will the organisation be in years time?
- How will the successful candidate contribute?
- What are the problems/opportunities facing the organisation/sector?
- What is the typical career path for someone in this role?
- How would you describe a typical day in this position?
- What are typical working hours ?
- Is overtime expected?
- What is your staff turnover?
- What is the reason for high/low staff retention?
- What training/development do you offer?
- How could I make a difference in the organisation/ the department?

Example questions for the end of the interview

- What else would you like to know about me?
- How suitable do you think I am for the role?
- What are the next steps in the interview process?
- Can I explain how keen I am on the role.....?